I also examine the response of the Indian people to the emergence and growth of British rule. Realising the significance of the decline of Indian culture and society by the eighteenth century, the Indians organised several social and religious ref.orm movements in the nineteenth century. This awakening in the nineteenth century not only adopted Western technology, like the printing press, to protest against British exploitation, but also resulted in assimilating Indians into prevailing world standards.

The last five chapters deal with the emergence of the nationalist movement in India, through the formation of the Indian National Congress, to the attainment of Indian independence. A detailed account is provided of the different strands that emerged within the national movement, like the moderate, the extremist and the revolutionary. The emergence of the mass phase of the Indian national movement under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi is dealt with extensively, without ignoring the multiple strands represented by Bhagat Singh, Jawaharlal Nehru, Subhas Bose and Jai Prakash Narayan. Certain individuals, who were the key figure in the national movement, have been discussed thoroughly, with an aim to showcase their contribution to the cause ofIndian independence. The growth and consolidation of communalist forces and the opposition of the nationalist movement towards its spread is innovatively presented, so as to highlight the hindrances of the one and the contribution of the other to the cause of Indian independence.

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